Express Autocare ERP — Quick Guide

Version 3 · October 2026: adds the WhatsApp inbox and Interakt in the CRM (section 2, 10) and fleet cabs & drivers (section 12).

One page per part of the system, in plain words. Each page says **what it is for**, **who uses it**, **what to do every day**, and **how it connects** to the rest.

> **Tip** if a menu item is missing, either your role does not use it, or the owner has switched that module off (Settings › Modules). Ask your manager.

0. Getting started (everyone)

Sign in

- Open the app link on your phone. Sign in with your **mobile number** (or email) and password.
- Install it like an app: browser menu › *Add to Home screen*.
- Forgot your password? Ask the owner/manager to reset it (Settings › Users).

Find your way

- **Menu** (left on a computer, *More* at the bottom right on a phone) is grouped: Home, CRM, Workshop, Customers, Parts & Stock, Billing, Accounts, People, Settings.
- The **bottom bar** on the phone shows the 4 screens you use most.
- **My Day** (Home) lists what you should do now — calls, messages, cars arriving, jobs, approvals. Start your day here.
- **Search** (magnifier at the top, or *Ctrl + K* on a computer): type a phone number, car number, job / bill / booking number or a name and jump straight to it.
- **Bell** at the top: alerts meant for you (new lead, job assigned, parts arrived, leave answered…). Tap to open.
- **Branch** selector (top, if you work at more than one branch) chooses whose data you see.

1. Attendance & leave (everyone) — People › My Attendance

Punch in / out

1. Be **at the workshop** with location (GPS) turned on.
2. Open **My Attendance** › tap **Punch in with a selfie** › the front camera opens › take the selfie.
3. Do the same when you leave (**Punch out**).

- The button only works inside the workshop area. A driver / home technician on a trip that day can punch from where they are.
- Forgot to punch? Tell your manager — they add it with a reason. You cannot edit punches yourself.

Your month — the calendar shows each day (green present, red absent, purple leave, grey weekly off). Tap a day for times, late minutes and overtime.

Leave — *Leave* tab › **Apply for leave** › type, dates (or half day), reason › Send. Your manager gets a bell and approves or rejects; you get a bell back. Paid leave beyond your balance is taken without pay.

Payslips — *Payslips* tab after the month's payroll is finalised; tap one for details or the PDF.

Money — *Advances* tab: salary advances still being recovered, and **customer money you hold** (see Billing). Hand customer money over at the counter; anything still with you at month end comes off your salary.

Location sharing (from punch in to punch out)

- When you punch in, the app shares your location with the owner and managers until you **punch out**. Nothing is shared after that or on days off. The first time, read the notice and tap **I understand, continue**.
- A small **green** line at the top of every screen says it is on. A **red** line means location is off or blocked: turn on Location (GPS) and allow it for the app.
- In the browser it works only while the app is open. **Field staff install the EA Workshop Android app**: it keeps sharing with the screen locked (allow Location and Notifications; set Battery to Unrestricted).

> **Connects to** Payroll (days, overtime, leave), CRM (new leads skip people on leave).

2. CRM & leads (marketing executives, advisors) — CRM

Where leads come from — Meta / Google ads and the website arrive by themselves; incoming calls, walk-ins and referrals you add with **Leads › Add lead** (mobile number is enough). A number that already has an open lead is updated, not duplicated. Each new lead is given to an executive in turn; you get a bell.

Every day — Leads › Today

1. **Call now — new leads** (red): call within 15 minutes. Speed wins bookings. If you don't, you get a reminder, then your manager is told.
2. **Follow-ups due**: hot (red dot) first.

On a lead

- **Call** (green) → after the call, choose what happened. The next follow-up is set for you (no answer → try in 2 hours, then tomorrow, then in 3 days).
- **Send prices** → pick the plan (and car type) → the message with prices and a booking link is ready → **Send on WhatsApp**.

- **Book** → day, free time slot, plan or repair, drive-in / pickup / home (with address) → Book.
- **Close as lost** needs a reason. "Not now" reasons keep sending a gentle message every few weeks.
- **Stop messages** if the person asks.

Messages to send (*CRM › Messages to send*) — follow-up creatives, quotes and booking messages wait here. Tap **Send on WhatsApp** → WhatsApp opens with the text → send → come back → the next one is ready.

WhatsApp Inbox (CRM › WhatsApp Inbox, when Interakt is on) — customers' and leads' WhatsApp chats.

- **Mine** = your leads, your open jobs' customers, chats given to you; **Nobody's** = not taken yet (Give to… yourself); managers also see **All**. Unread chats show a green number and ring your bell.
- **Someone new writes in → a lead is made by itself** (source WhatsApp chat), given to the next executive. A chat starting with a campaign's WhatsApp start text becomes that campaign's lead. A customer with a car in the workshop goes to that job's advisor.
- **Reply** with text, a photo or a PDF for **24 hours after their last message**; after that only a template (e.g. Chat opener) — their reply opens the chat again. Ticks: ✓ sent, ✓✓ delivered, blue ✓✓ read, ⚠ not delivered.
- Button taps on our messages (**Interested / Call me / Not now**) move the lead by themselves. The lead page shows the same chat.

Bookings (*CRM › Bookings*) — today's slots and who is coming.

- Online bookings (customers book themselves from their link) show **To confirm** — call and **Confirm**.
- **Car arrived** (drive-in) → check the car number / type → the **job card form opens already filled**.
- Pickup / home bookings open the job card and the driver's trip as soon as they are confirmed.
- **Move**, **Cancel**, or **Did not come** (also marked automatically 3 hours after the slot).

What happens by itself — after delivery the customer gets a thank-you with a 1-tap rating and a referral link; low ratings alert the manager. Cars due for service, pending work, insurance renewal and customers who have not come for months get reminders and appear as leads to call.

> **Connects to** Job cards (booking → job card), Billing (won leads carry the bill amount), Payroll (incentive per converted lead), Customers (full history on the customer page).

3. Customers & vehicles (advisors, front desk) — Customers

- **Customers › New**: name, mobile, *How did they find us*. Then **Add Vehicle** (car number and **car type** — needed for plan prices).
- The customer page shows visits, total spent, rating, credit, next service due and one **history** of enquiries, bookings, jobs, bills and messages. **Book a service** from here.

> **Connects to** CRM, Job cards, Billing (customer credit).

4. Job cards & the workshop (advisors, technicians, managers) — Workshop › Job Cards

Open a job card — from a booking (*Car arrived*), or **Job Cards › New**: customer, car, service plan (or a repair type), engine oil, odometer and fuel, customer complaints one per line. Then assign the technician(s) and bay.

The job moves on by itself through its stages: intake → estimate & approval → work → parts → trial → wash → final QC → bill → gate pass → delivered. Each stage sends the customer its WhatsApp message (when set).

Advisor

- **Intake**: trial drive, photos / videos of the car.
- **Estimate**: plan lines plus additional work and parts → send to the customer; they approve or decline each line on their link (declined items are kept as "Recommended but not approved").
- Parts the technician needs: review and forward them to the parts coordinator.
- After the work: record **Trial drive OK** and **Washing done**.

Technician (*My Jobs*) — open the job sheet, mark each activity Done / N/A with the photos or videos it asks for, add **Additional Issues** with a photo of the faulty part, list parts needed, **Submit to SA for Parts**. Fit the new part only after it arrives (photo of the fitted part), then Done. Submit the sheet when finished.

Manager — final QC spot-check (photo within 30 seconds), override when needed (always with a reason).

> **Connects to** Parts, Billing (the bill is made from the estimate), CRM (delivery wins the lead, starts feedback).

5. Pickup, drop & home service (drivers, home technicians) — My Trips / Pickups & Drops

- **Driver**: *My Trips* lists your pickups and drops. **Start** → navigate → **Arrived** → odometer, fuel and photos/videos (the pickup *is* the intake) → **Collected**. For a drop you need the gate pass and the handover photos.
- **Home technician**: the visit has its own job sheet; close the visit with the photos asked for.
- **Advisor** books trips on the job card or from a CRM booking; the board shows today's trips.
- **EA Workshop Android app** (drivers, home technicians): install the APK your manager sends, enter the **server address** shown on Settings › App Address & Customer App, sign in. Your location then follows the trip even with the screen locked, and customers see you coming in their app.

> **Connects to** Job cards, Billing (pickup / home charges go on the bill), Attendance (punch from the trip).

6. Parts & purchases (parts coordinator) — Parts & Stock

- **Parts Desk**: parts requested by advisors → get supplier prices → after the customer approves, order them → mark them received (or receive them on a GRN, below). Technician and advisor get a bell.
- *If Purchases & stock is on:* **GRN** for every supplier bill — photo of each part, GST bill or not, credit or cash. The technician confirms right / wrong part. **Stock** for oil and consumables; **plan kits** are issued to jobs. **Suppliers** shows what we owe and records payments.

> **Connects to** Job cards, Billing (bill waits for parts on a GRN), Accounts (purchases and supplier dues).

7. Billing & payments (back office, advisors) — Billing and the job card's Billing & Delivery

1. Take **advances** any time (job card › Billing › Record payment). A payment can be split: cash + UPI + card. **Collected by staff**: the customer paid an employee's own UPI / cash — choose the employee; they hold it until handed over.
2. After final QC: **Make bill** (proforma) → check lines → **Approve** → the customer pays the balance.
3. **Convert to tax invoice** (or close a paid proforma).
4. Paid in full → the **gate pass** is issued by itself → **Vehicle out** delivers the job.

- Paid too much? **Refund** it or keep it as **customer credit** (usable on a later job).
- A gate pass before full payment needs the owner / manager and a reason.

UPI payments from the customer app

1. Customers pay the balance by UPI in the app and send the **UPI reference (UTR)**. You get a bell: **UPI payment to confirm**.
2. Open **Billing › UPI Payments to Confirm** and check the amount and UTR in the bank.
3. Found: **Confirm & record** (recorded on the job as UPI; the customer sees "Received"). Not found: **Reject** with a reason the customer sees.

> **Connects to** Accounts (every bill and payment is posted), CRM (bill amount = lead revenue), Attendance & payroll (staff-held money).

8. Accounts (back office, owner) — Accounts

- **Nothing to type for bills, receipts, GRNs or payroll** — they post to the books by themselves.

- **Expenses**: *Add expense* — date, what for, paid to, amount, paid from (cash / bank / a supplier on credit / customer money held by staff), GST bill or not, photo of the bill.
- **Cash ↔ bank** (cash deposited) and **Journal voucher** for anything else; **Opening balances** once at the start.
- **Accounts & Reports**: Profit & loss, Balance sheet, Cash & bank book, Who owes (customers, suppliers, staff), **GST** summary for the CA, Day book, Ledgers, Trial balance, **Export CSV**.
- The owner can **lock** a finished month (*Settings › Chart of Accounts*).

Connects to Billing, Parts, Payroll, CRM (referral rewards).

9. Payroll & staff (back office, owner, managers) — People

- **Attendance Register**: everyone's day with selfies; tap a person to add a missed punch or remove a wrong one (always with a reason). Month grid for the whole team.
- **Leave Requests**: approve / reject.
- **Employees**: designation, branch, shift, weekly off, joining date; salary, OT rate, off-day pay, PT / PF / ESI, bank (only those who prepare payroll see pay).
- **Payroll** each month: *Work out a month* → check each payslip (correct a line with a reason if needed) → the **owner finalises** after the month ends → **Mark paid**. Add incentives, bonus, deductions or penalties under *Manual lines*; automatic incentives come from the rules.
- **Staff Money & Advances**: give an advance (recovered monthly), record customer money handed over.
- **Live Staff Map** (owner, managers): everyone punched in today on a map — moving, not moving, **no signal** (call them), battery, the trip they are on. Tap a person for the day's route: km travelled, stops, gaps; pick a date for earlier days. Switch it off for one person in Employees (tick "Share live location").

Connects to Attendance, Billing (staff-held money), CRM (lead incentives), Accounts (salary cost and payments).

10. Settings (owner, managers) — Settings

All masters on one page, grouped and searchable: job sheets & stages, plans & prices, CRM (journeys — which creative goes when —, creatives, lead sources & webhook links, campaigns & ad spend, booking slots, lost reasons, rules), purchases, HR & payroll (pay & OT, shifts, holidays, leave types, incentive rules), accounts, users, branches (workshop location for attendance), roles.

Modules (owner) — switch **Purchases & stock**, **Accounts**, **CRM & leads**, **Attendance & payroll** and the Customer app on or off. Nothing is deleted. After switching Accounts back on, use *Bring the books up to date*.

App Address & Customer App (owner) — the public address of the system (every link to customers uses it; leave it empty while testing), a QR code for setting up staff phones, the **UPI ID** customers pay to, the helpline number, sign-in code validity, phone notifications, and a QR to print for customers.

Fleet cabs (same page) — how much a fleet's driver may approve per job, and how close to its service (km) a cab gets before the owner and drivers are reminded.

WhatsApp & Interakt (owner) — Settings › CRM › WhatsApp & Interakt (was Settings › WhatsApp). **Connection**: share links (default) or **Interakt**; paste the API key, put the webhook URL and the same secret key in Interakt; switches for new chats → leads, contacts / events to Interakt, give chats in Interakt too. "What Interakt has sent us" shows whether chats, ticks and taps arrive (incoming chats need Interakt's higher plan). **Templates & buttons**: Fetch from Interakt, pick the approved template for each message, choose what each quick-reply button does. **Contacts & events**: leads and customers go to Interakt every 15 minutes; events (LeadCreated, BookingConfirmed, JobDelivered, ServiceDue…) can start Interakt campaigns; **Send all contacts now** once.

AI Assistant (owner) — the customer app's assistant: Anthropic API key, model (Opus 5.5 best, Sonnet 5.5 half the cost, Haiku 5.5 cheapest), questions per customer per day, monthly budget in ₹ (it pauses when reached), the body-shop price guide, and what it was asked this month.

Live location (Pay, OT, Statutory & Live Location) — on / off for everyone, how often phones send a position, "No signal" after how many minutes, how long positions are kept.

Customer app — switch it on or off in Modules (job and CRM links keep working either way).

11. Customer app (advisors, back office) — what customers see at <address>/app

Customers have their own app, **Express Autocare**, at the system's address + **/app**. It works in any phone browser and installs like an app (Android: Install; iPhone: Share › Add to Home Screen). Every WhatsApp job page has **Open in the Express Autocare app**.

What customers can do

- **Home**: jobs in progress and what needs them; their cars with service, insurance and PUC dates.
- **Job**: stages, photos and videos, **approve / decline** each item ("Why is this needed?" when the assistant is on), the report and bill, the **driver on a map**, and **Pay by UPI**.
- **Service book**: every visit of each car, work recommended earlier, a history PDF.
- **Book**: a plan at their car's own price or a repair; pickup, home or drive-in; a free slot.
- **Inbox**: job updates, payments, reminders (service due, insurance, PUC, documents, pending work); phone notifications if installed.
- **Wallet** (credit, referral link), **Documents** (insurance, PUC, RC, licence with expiry reminders), **Ask** (the AI assistant: what's wrong, accident help).

What staff do

- **Sign-in codes**: customers sign in by opening any WhatsApp link from us, or with their number and a code. While Interakt is off, **open the customer's page (Customers) › Customer app card and read out the code** — only to their own number. You also get a bell.

- **UPI payments**: Billing › UPI Payments to Confirm (section 7).
- **App bookings** arrive in CRM › Bookings as "Booked online" with a bell: call to confirm.
- **Accident help** requests arrive as body-shop leads with the assistant's summary: call the customer.

> **Careful** The assistant gives likely causes and price ranges from our own price lists, never a diagnosis or a quote; the workshop's inspection decides. It stays off until the owner switches it on.

12. Fleet cabs & drivers (advisors, managers) — Customers and Customers › Fleet Reports

- **Make a cab owner a fleet**: customer page › **Fleet** card › tick **Cab fleet**. Add the cabs as vehicles, then **Add driver** (name, mobile, their cabs). The owner can also add drivers in the app.
- **Drivers sign in** to the customer app with their own number (code read out from the fleet's Customer app card) or their job link. They see only their cabs; no wallet, no adding cars.
- **Driver's limit**: a driver approves extra work up to a total per job (default in Settings › App Address & Customer App, or the fleet's own). Above it the owner is asked (app + WhatsApp) and the advisor gets a bell. Drivers may decline; they can't change the owner's answers.
- **Job card**: choose the **Driver who brought the cab**; they get the stages in the app and a WhatsApp "cab ready" message. Fleets pay per job as usual.
- **Fleet Reports**: problems drivers report (breakdowns first, with photos, km and location) → **Book in** (drive-in or pickup), **Open job card**, or **Close** with a note. Driver and owner are told each step.
- **In the app**: the owner gets the **Fleet dashboard** (each cab at the workshop or on the road, approvals waiting, money due, km, next service, spend) and **Drivers**; drivers get **Report a problem** and **Log km**. Cabs near their service km get a reminder once.

> **Note** Whole feature: Settings › Modules › Fleet cabs & drivers.

How it all connects — one car's journey

1. **Ad / call / referral** → **Lead** (CRM) → called, prices sent → **Booking**.
2. **Booking** → car arrives (or driver picks it up) → **Job card** filled in from the booking.
3. **Estimate** → customer approves on WhatsApp or in the customer app → **Parts** ordered / received (GRN) → technician works.
4. Trial, wash, final QC → **Bill** → **Payments** (at the counter, by staff, or UPI in the customer app) → **Gate pass** → **Vehicle out**.
5. **Accounts** record the sale, GST, payments and parts cost by themselves.

6. **CRM** marks the lead won with the bill amount → thank-you + rating + referral link → next service reminder.
7. **Payroll** counts attendance, overtime and incentives (including converted leads) at month end.